Money Laundering Typologies — Dataset Ground Truth

Reference sheet — Week 2, Day 2: AML Typology Research (HI-Small_Patterns.txt)

Labels Found in HI-Small_Patterns.txt (Ground Truth)

8 concrete laundering pattern variants are labeled directly in the dataset's pattern file.

Dataset Label	Attempts	Maps To	Description
CYCLE	54	Circular	Funds return to the original sender through a chain of accounts.
GATHER-SCATTER	51	Fan-In → Fan-Out	Funds gathered into a hub account, then scattered out to many accounts.
BIPARTITE	49	Smurfing	Many-to-many transfers between two groups of accounts.
FAN-OUT	48	Fan-Out	One sender distributes funds to many receivers.
SCATTER-GATHER	44	Fan-Out → Fan-In	Funds scattered out first, then gathered back into one account.
STACK	43	Layering	Funds passed sequentially through a chain of intermediate accounts.
RANDOM	41	Pass-through / unstructured	No single clear structure; opportunistic or mixed behavior.
FAN-IN	40	Fan-In	Many senders consolidate funds into one receiver.

Total: 370 labeled laundering attempts, 3,209 individual transaction rows, across 8 pattern types.
Why criminals use these: Fan-Out/Fan-In spread or consolidate funds to avoid single-account scrutiny; Layering and Circular patterns obscure origin through distance or false legitimacy; Smurfing avoids mandatory reporting thresholds; Pass-through/unstructured activity adds separation between source and destination.